



Security Council

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Agenda: Analysing the potential use of Autonomous AI weapons in warfare

Sponsors: Co-operative Republic of Guyana, Hellenic Republic, Peoples Republic of China

Signatories: United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland, French Republic, Russian Federation, The United States of America, People's Democratic Republic of Algeria, Kingdom of Denmark, The Islamic Republic of Pakistan, Republic of Panama, Republic of Sierra Leone, Republic of Slovenia, Federal Republic of Somalia, Republic of South Korea, Argentina Republic, People's Republic of Bangladesh, Brunei Darussalam, The Kingdom of Belgium, Dominion of Canada, The Arab Republic of Egypt, Federal Republic of Germany, Republic of India, Republic of Indonesia, Islamic Republic of Iran, State of Israel, The Italian Republic, Japan, Republic of Lebanon, Netherlands, State of Palestine, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia, Kingdom of Sweden, Syrian Arab Republic, United Arab Emirates

The Security Council,

Recalling the core principles of International Humanitarian Law (IHL), as codified in the Geneva Conventions of 1949 and Additional Protocol I of 1977, which require belligerents to distinguish between civilian and military targets (Article 48), prohibit indiscriminate attacks on civilian populations (Article 51(2–5)), and mandate the taking of all feasible precautions to avoid or minimize civilian harm (Article 57(2) (a–c)),

Emphasising that under Article 36 of Additional Protocol I of 1977, each member state is obligated to conduct legal reviews of any new weapons, means, or methods of warfare to determine their compliance with international law, particularly in terms of their effects on civilians and civilian objects,

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Alarmed by multiple real-world incidents where autonomous weapons systems (AWS) were deployed and caused indiscriminate harm to civilian populations and infrastructure, including the use of Kargu-2 drones by Turkey in Libya, as noted by the UN Panel of Experts Report on Libya (March 2021); the deployment of Harop loitering munitions during the 2020 Nagorno-Karabakh conflict, as recorded in the International Crisis Group Report No. 264 (2021); and drone strikes during the Tigray conflict in Ethiopia (2020–2022) that lacked meaningful human oversight, as documented in the UN Human Rights Council Report [A/HRC/51/46 \(2022\)](#),

Noting further with concern the difficulty in attributing legal responsibility when autonomous weapons systems (AWS) cause unlawful harm to civilians, which complicates enforcement of the Rome Statute of the International Criminal Court of 1998, particularly Article 7 on crimes against humanity when civilian harm is widespread or systematic, and Article 8(2)(b)(iv), which prohibits disproportionate attacks on civilian objects relative to the anticipated military advantage,

Recognising the warning issued in the UN Secretary-General's 2023 Policy Brief on "A New Agenda for Peace," which urges member states to prohibit the use of AWS that cannot meet the standards of accountability and legality under existing humanitarian law,

Recalling United Nations Security Council Resolutions [1325 \(2000\)](#) and [2417 \(2018\)](#), both of which call for the protection of civilians in armed conflict and stress the importance of accountability in situations where force is used indiscriminately against infrastructure essential to civilian life,

Welcoming the discussions and progress of the Group of Governmental Experts (GGE) on Lethal Autonomous Weapons Systems (LAWS) under the Convention on Certain Conventional Weapons (CCW) from 2017 to 2023, which have reaffirmed the need for meaningful human control and legal accountability, but regrettably acknowledging the lack of a binding international legal instrument to regulate AWS use in populated areas,

Reaffirming the United Nations General Assembly Resolution [76/129 \(2021\)](#) titled "Impact of new technologies on international security and disarmament," which emphasises the ethical and legal implications of new weapons systems, including autonomous systems empowered by artificial intelligence,

Deeply concerned that the dual-use nature of many Artificial Intelligence-enabled weapons means that civilian infrastructure, such as hospitals, power grids, and transportation networks, may be unintentionally targeted or disproportionately affected, thereby violating the principle of proportionality under International Humanitarian Law (IHL) and breaching Article 10 of the United Nations Basic Principles on the Protection of Civilian Infrastructure of 2005,

Taking into consideration the Organisation of Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) Recommendation on Artificial Intelligence of 2019, which, while non-binding, urges transparency, accountability, and human-centricity in the use of

Artificial Intelligence systems, principles that are regularly undermined when autonomous weapons are deployed without oversight,

Reaffirming the provisions of the United Nations Charter, particularly Article 1(1), which calls for the maintenance of international peace and security through collective action, and Article 24(1), which places primary responsibility for peace and security upon the Security Council,

Deeply disturbed that the continued deployment of autonomous weapons systems (AWS) without proper legal assessments may breach the Martens Clause, originally formulated in the Hague Convention II (1899) and reaffirmed in Additional Protocol I, which upholds the principles of public conscience and humanity in warfare, especially when legal frameworks lag behind technological realities,

Affirming the ethical guidance provided by the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organisation's (UNESCO) 2021 Recommendation on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence, which warns against the weaponisation of AI and urges nations to prohibit systems that cannot conform to international human rights or humanitarian standards,

Reaffirms the importance of enforcing of protecting data of a member state and enforcing data sovereignty, ensuring that the data is not used by parties without legal consent from the nations,

1. *Urges* the member states to declare a ban on the development and deployment of fully autonomous lethal weapons (AWS) until a multilateral consensus on international legal standards is achieved fully;
2. *Expresses its hope* to define 'meaningful human control' as the ability of a human operator to intervene, override, and supervise the actions of an Artificial Intelligence weapons system at any point in its performance;
3. *Recommends* the International Law Commission (ILC) to inspect the development of the legal framework for imposing accountability and responsibility on states, entities, developers, and military personnel in cases of violation of international humanitarian law involving autonomous weapons;
4. *Encourages* the International Criminal Court (ICC) to inspect jurisdictional measures for prosecuting violations of the usage of autonomous weapons where command responsibility can be established;
5. *Recommends that* the United Nations General Assembly consider the incorporation of an intergovernmental group under its First Committee to examine the drafting of a new international treaty on Lethal Autonomous Weapons (AWS), while reaffirming the continuing adherence to the Geneva Conventions and International Humanitarian Laws (IHL);
6. *Calls for* the formation of a United Nations Security Council Technological Oversight Subcommittee on Emerging Military Artificial Intelligence to issue compliance advisories, review global developments, and flag violations that threaten peace and stability;

7. *Calls upon* the Secretary-General to issue a report on the military use of Artificial Intelligence and verification of compliance by member states;
 8. *Encourages* the states to enter into peaceful arms control dialogues on restricting the speed, scope, and secrecy of Artificial Intelligence Weapons development;
 9. *Recommends that* the United Nations Counter Terrorism Executive Directorate (UNCTED) strengthen its monitoring of transactional black-market networks for trafficking in artificial intelligence weapon components;
 10. *Expresses its appreciation* of national legislation criminalising the illegal sale, transfer, and production of autonomous weapon systems (AWS) and related artificial intelligence software related to non-state actors.
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